the letter could as well be part of a statement by officials of independent India after 1947.

In 1921 the Congress passed a resolution that repudiated the aggressive policies of the Raj and reassured foreign countries, especially India's neighbours, that upon attainment of self-government, India's foreign policy would be one of friendship towards all. In 1925, at the fortieth session of the Congress party in Kanpur, a resolution was passed for the need 'to look after the interests of Indians abroad and to carry on educative propaganda in the country regarding their position in the British Empire and foreign countries'. [72]

A resolution passed at the Madras session in 1927 declared: 'The people of India have no quarrels with their neighbours and desire to live at peace with them and assert their right to determine whether or not they will take part in any war. The Congress demands that these war preparations be put an end to and further declares that in the event of the British government embarking on any war-like adventure and endeavouring to exploit India in it for furtherance of their imperialist aims it will be the duty of the people of India to refuse to take any part in such a war or cooperate with them in any way whatsoever.'[73]

The 1928 Calcutta session resolution declared: '… that the Congress has taken a decision to develop contacts with other countries and peoples who also suffer under imperialism and desire to combat it.' [74] The Congress resolutions also put forth the concept of an Asia whose fate is tied together. This idea was put forth at the 1926 Gauhati session as well as at the 1928 Calcutta session that sought a conference on Asia in 1930.[75] This finally materialized in the form of the March 1947 Asian Relations Conference.

In 1936 Jawaharlal Nehru inaugurated the foreign department of the Congress and in 1940 a separate Indians Overseas Department was set up. The Congress also supported freedom struggles in other colonies and countries. It built ties with the Wafd party in Egypt, the Kuomintang in